

## 1. INDIA-EGYPT DEFENCE COOPERATION (GS II - IR)

### STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP: BEYOND THE SUEZ

➤ 11<sup>th</sup> JOINT DEFENCE COMMITTEE (JDC) MEETING (CAIRO, APRIL 2026)

➤ BILATERAL DEFENCE COOPERATION PLAN (2026-27):

- ↳ Structured Military Interaction
- ↳ Joint Training & complex multi-domain Exercises

➤ DEFENCE INDUSTRY:

- ↳ CO-DEVELOPMENT & CO-PRODUCTION
- ↳ India pitched 'MAKE IN INDIA, MAKE FOR EGYPT' (Leveraging \$20B domestic capacity)



#### MARITIME SECURITY:

- ↳ NAVY-TO-NAVY STAFF TALKS
- ↳ INDIAN OCEAN REGION (IOR) & SUEZ CANAL (Strategic status as gateway)
- ↳ Egypt tracks threats via India's INFORMATION FUSION CENTRE-IOR (IFC-IOR)

## 3. ECONOMY CHALLENGES OF WAR (GS III - ECONOMY)

### GLOBAL CONFLICTS & INDIA'S POLYCRISIS SCENARIO

➤ MACROECONOMIC IMPACT:

- ↳ CRUDE OIL: Imported Inflation. (+\$10/bar = +CAD ~0.5% of GDP)
- ↳ FUEL!: Imported Inflation(+\$10/bar = +CAD ~0.5% of GDP)
- ↳ FERTILIZERS: Disrupted NPK supply chains (Russia/Belarus). Spikes Food Subsidies, Food Security risks
- ↳ REMITTANCES: Instability in West Asia threatens inflows (~\$100B+ for India). Balance of Payments effect



MICROECONOMIC EFFECTS:

- ↳ SUPPLY CHAIN SQUEEZE: Higher freight rates (e.g., Red Sea crisis). Increases 'Cost of Doing Business'
- ↳ GLOBAL DEMAND: Slowdown reduces EXPORTS for MSMEs (textiles, gems, jewelry)
- ↳ INPUT COSTS: Affects farmers via high diesel & fertilizer prices. 'PROFITABILITY CRISES' in agriculture



## 2. TUTI ISLAND: GEOGRAPHY OF KHARTOUM (GS I - GEOGRAPHY)

### THE HEART OF KHARTOUM AT THE CONFLUENCE



THE CONFLUENCE:

- ↳ BLUE NILE (from Lake Tana, Ethiopia)
- ↳ WHITE NILE (from Lake Victoria)

FORMATION:

- ↳ Crescent-shaped RIVER ISLAND (~8 sq. km)
- ↳ Result of centuries of SILT DEPOSITION

'TAYA' SYSTEM (Indigenous early-warning):

- ↳ Residents use DRUMS & MONITORING TENTS to predict season surges
- ↳ Example of COMMUNITY-BASED DISASTER RISK MANAGEMENT (CBDRM)

STRATEGIC STATUS:

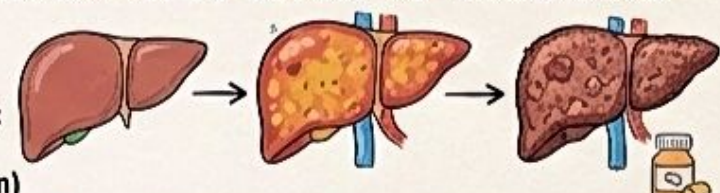
- ↳ 'RURAL EYE' in the city. Key for agriculture
- ↳ Threats: Climate change, upstream damming

## 4. LIVER FIBROSIS & NASH (GS III - S&T/HEALTH)

### THE SILENT EPIDEMIC: FROM FATTY LIVER TO CIRRHOSIS

➤ PROGRESSION:

1. STEATOSIS (Simple fatty liver)
2. NASH (Non-Alcoholic Steatohepatitis: Inflammation + damage)
3. FIBROSIS (Excess scar tissue/collagen)
4. CIRRHOSIS (Advanced scarring, Liver Failure, HCC/Cancer)



➤ PREVALENCE RISKS:

- ↳ Strong correlation with TYPE-2 DIABETES (T2DM)
- ↳ BMI > 30 (Obesity)
- ↳ 25-30% global adult population has hepatic steatosis

THE 'LIFESTYLE' FACTOR & REVERSIBILITY:

- ↳ High fructose/ultra-processed food, low physical activity
- ↳ 10% Weight Loss = 90% NASH resolution & 45% fibrosis regression



➤ UPSC NOTE: Mention National Programme for Prevention and Control of NCDs (NPCDCS)

**\*UPSC Tip: For 2026, link Tuti Island to 'Nile Water Conflict' (GERD) and Liver Fibrosis to 'National Health Mission' targets.\***

# UPSC CSE 2026 FOCUS: GLOBAL HEALTH & CLIMATE ADAPTATION

## PAGI 1: WHO PANDEMIC AGREEMENT

(78th World Health Assembly, 20 May 2025)



### CONTEXT & AIMS

- rectify 'catastrophic failures' of COVID-19
- establish legally binding framework for 194 Member States

### ONE HEALTH APPROACH



### KEY MECHANISMS

'THE HEART OF THE AGREEMENT'

#### PABS

(PATHOGEN ACCESS & BENEFIT-SHARING)

- Guaranteed share of vaccines, e.g., 20%
- From shared samples

#### GSCL

(GLOBAL SUPPLY CHAIN & LOGISTICS)

- Network to prevent 'vaccine nationalism'
- Equitable distribution

#### COORDINATING FINANCIAL MECHANISM

- Pooled resources for preparedness in resource-limited settings

### WAY FORWARD

- OPERATIONALIZING ANNEXES
  - Finalizing PABS technical details

### CORE PRINCIPLES

- AIMS TO FIX GLOBAL FAILURE, EQUITY & COLLECTIVE SECURITY
- Integrated surveillance
- recognizing interdependence of human, animal, environmental health



### CHALLENGES & INEQUITIES

- 摩擦 BINDING COMMITMENTS
  - Developed nations resist tech transfer, IP waivers
- THE 'HYBRID' DILEMMA
  - Immediate pathogen sharing vs deferred benefits
- SOVEREIGNTY VS. SURVEILLANCE
  - National rights vs international oversight

- RATIFICATION
  - Sustained political will to move from adoption to implementation

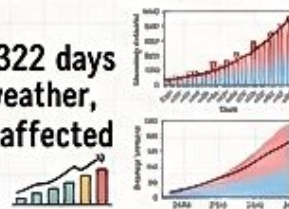
## PAGI 2: CLIMATE ADAPTATION

(India's Resiliency Path)



### VULNERABILITY CONTEXT

- India among most climate-vulnerable
- 1905-2024: over 430 extreme events
- 2024 alone: 322 days of extreme weather
- 90% of year affected intensifying



### EXISTING INITIATIVES

- MISSION LIFE: individual behavioral changes
- NAPCC: 8-9 Missions like Water, Agriculture, Solar
- CDRI: India-led global initiative for resilient infrastructure

### WAY FORWARD

- NATURE-BASED SOLUTIONS (NbS): mangrove restoration, urban forests for floods/heat
- CLIMATE-SMART AGRICULTURE: scaling pest/disease-resistant crop varieties to protect land

### THE ADAPTATION MANDATE

- NDCs: MAIN STREAMING ADAPTATION
  - embedding climate resilience into national development, infrastructure, agriculture

### KEY CHALLENGES

- DATA GAPS: hyper-local data for 'last-mile' adaptation sparse
- THE 'UNMET COOLING' DEMAND
  - Heatwaves intensify (affect 71%),
  - cooling demand vs renewable capacity
- FINANCE & TECHNOLOGY: significant 'funding gaps' in adaptation

### WAY FORWARD



- CLIMATE-SMART AGRICULTURE: scaling pest/disease-resistant crop varieties to protect hectares damaged)
- GLOCALIZED FINANCE: leveraging international funds + local green bonds for community resilience

# UPSC CSE 2026: KEY SOCIETAL, TECHNICAL, & GOVERNANCE TRENDS

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## 1. SOCIAL MOBILITY & CULTURAL LEGACY

### MECHANISMS OF SOCIAL STRATIFICATION

NOTE:

- **SANSKRITISATION:** Adopting twice-born customs (rituals, vegetarianism) for higher status.
- **KSHATRIYAISATION:** Claiming warrior status, linking lineage to **REGIONAL WARRIOR FIGURES** (e.g., Mihir Bhoj, Suheldev).
- **CULTURAL LEGACY & POLITICS:** Using historical symbols for **POLITICAL MOBILISATION**.
- **STRATEGIC REINTERPRETATION:** Re-reading history to create 'vote banks' and new narratives.

NOTE:



## 2. ENVIRONMENTAL TECH & FIREWORKS SAFETY

### GREENER VISUAL EFFECTS

FROM TRADITIONAL to SUSTAINABLE

- **FIREWORKS SAFETY:** Moving from toxic chemical crackers to clean alternatives.
- **COLD SPARK TECH:** Granular power of titanium/zirconium, non-flammable sparks (safe 15-20°C).
- **PYROTECHNIC SIMULATION:** Using lasers and drones for Visual Effects; zero pollution.
- **POLICY SHIFT:** SC bans & shift to 'Green Crackers' by CSIR-NEERI.

NOTE:



## 3. GOVERNANCE: WOMEN POLITICAL REPRESENTATION BILL

THE CONSTITUTION (106<sup>th</sup> AMENDMENT) ACT, 2023 - 33% RESERVATION

### FACTORS AFFECTING REPRESENTATION:



**PATRIARCHAL NORMS:**  
View leadership as male domain.



**HOUSEHOLD RESPONSIBILITY:**  
The 'Double Burden' on women.



**FINANCE/POLITICAL STRUCTURE:**  
High campaign costs & party gatekeeping.



**INDIVIDUAL BARRIERS:**  
Lower networking, 'perceived' experience gap.



**CULTURAL NORMS:**  
Restrictive societal roles.

### WOMEN ELECTORAL PARTICIPATION PARADOX



Trend: Record high turnout.

**RURAL HIGH:** Active via PRIs (Panchayati Raj Institutions, 33-50% reservation).

**URBAN LOW:** Less consistent turnout.

### VALUE ADDITION FOR MAINS

- "You can tell the condition of a nation by looking at the status of its women." - NEHRU
- Case studies: 'LAKHPATI DIDI'
- 'LAKHPATI DIDI' and 'SELF HELP GROUPS (SHGs)'

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